



Redesigning the

Town of Brookline

Introduction

Redesigning the Town of Brookline

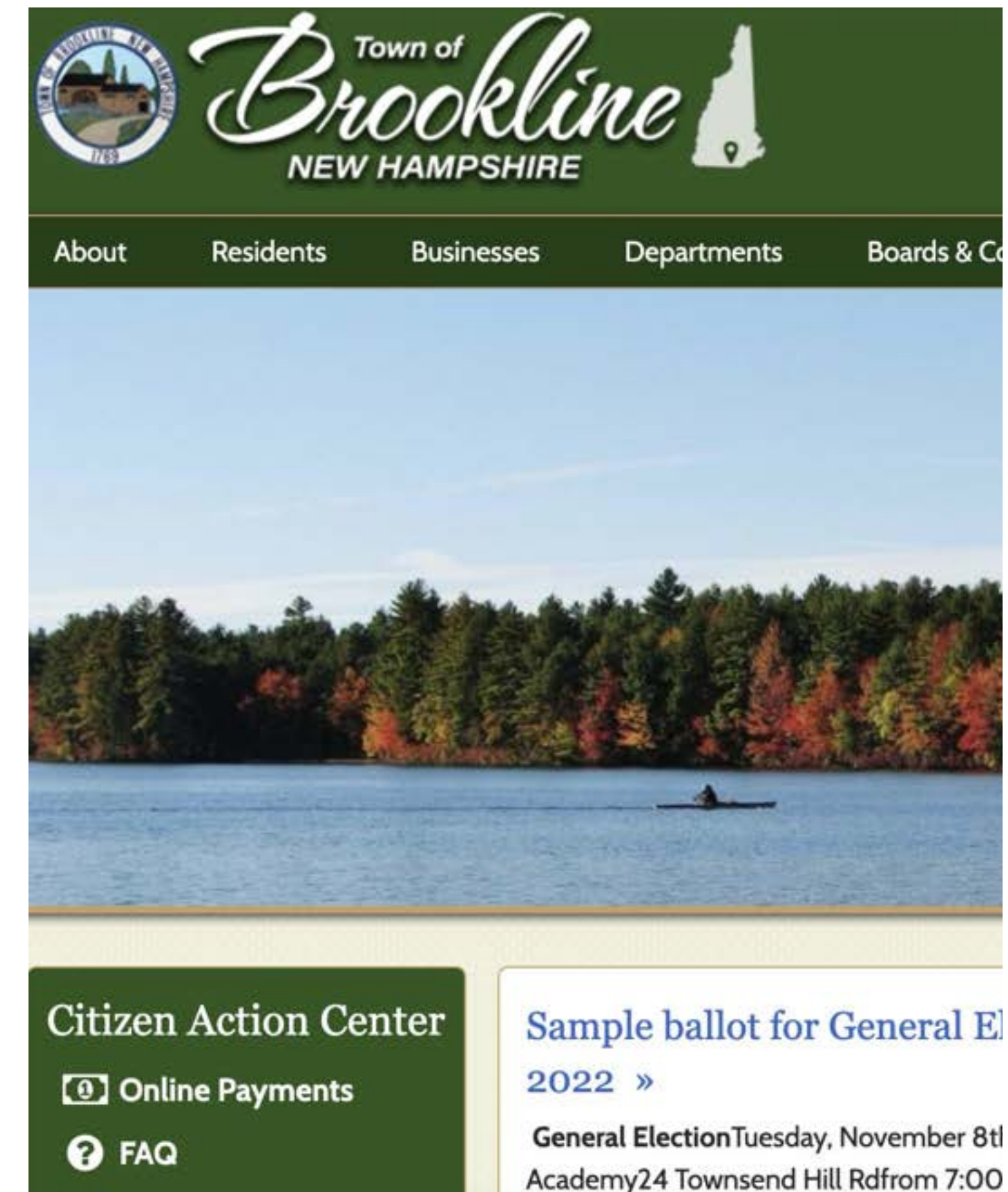
Narrowing in my sights on a small town website redesign, I turned to the town of Brookline, New Hampshire. How could the town's heavy emphasis on community-building, their school district, and the outdoors be translated into their website?

First, let's analyze their current website...

Research > The Problems

Lacks Personality

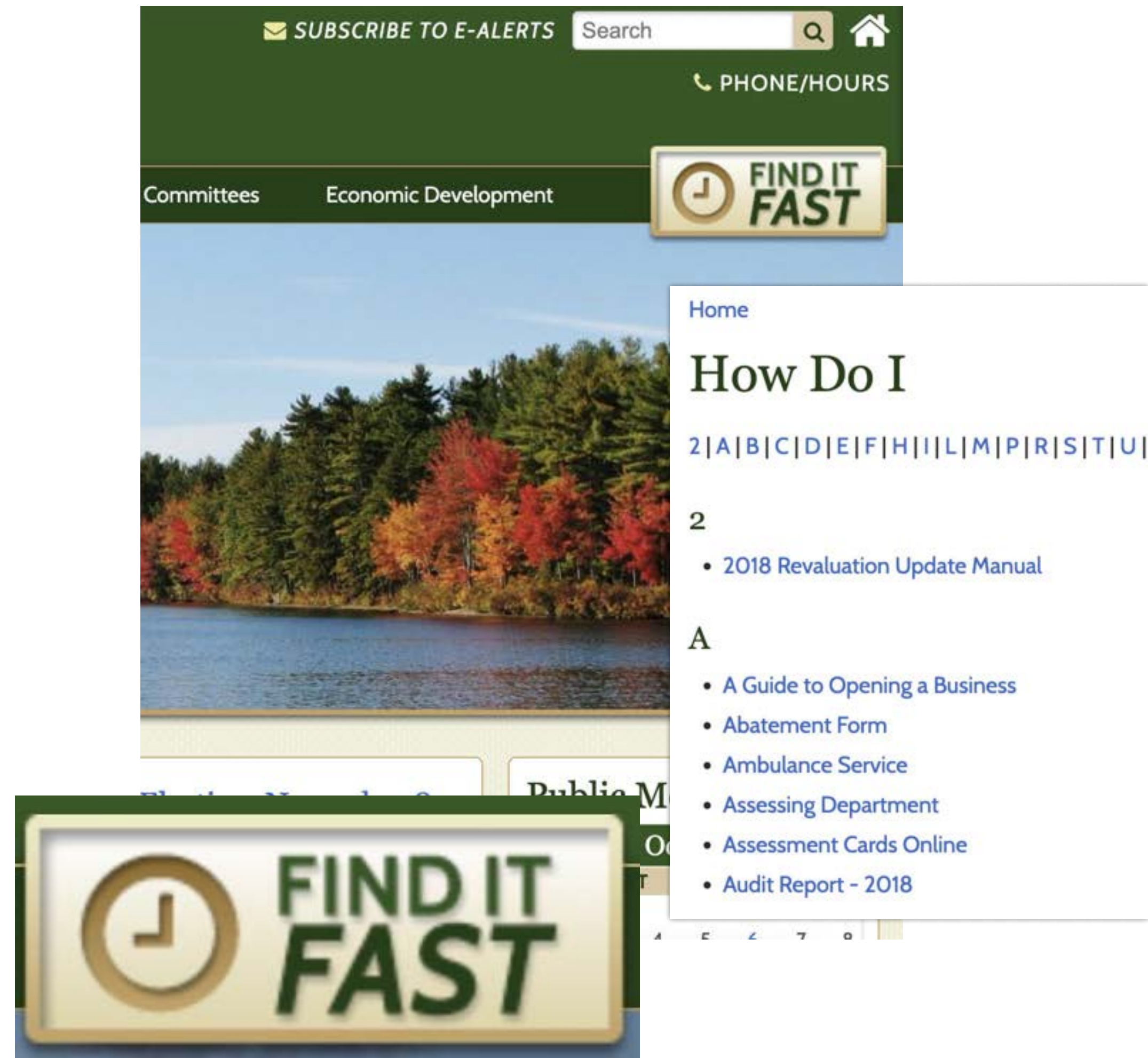
What does this say about the town? The website does not represent the young and thriving community within the town. It is generic and plain.



Research > The Problems

Find it Fast

Find it fast... isn't fast? The page doesn't make it easy nor quick to find certain phrases or terms. This feature is also redundant with the search bar. The navigation needs to be more concise.



Research > The Problems

Old Content

The visual and written content as well as the layout does not show the recent activities or events of the town. It is hard to gauge what the community is like because nothing indicates the personality of the town.

Sample ballot for General Election, November 8, 2022 »

General ElectionTuesday, November 8thCaptain Samuel Douglass Academy24 Townsend Hill Rdfrom 7:00am-7:...

Senior Citizen Active Walking Program »

The NH Wellpoint Foundation is once again offering the Winter Walking Program for Brookline residents age 70+ at The...

Supervisors of the October 31 »

Public Notice to the Citizen



Community Events

« October »						
S	M	T	W	T	F	S
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31					

Brookline Public Library "Trunk or Treat"
October 29, 2022 - 2:30pm to 4:00pm

Scouting for Food
November 12, 2022 - 8:30am to 12:00pm

Public Meetings

« October »						
S	M	T	W	T	F	S
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31					

Cemetery Trustees Meeting
October 28, 2022 - 10:30am

Supervisors of the Checklist Session Monday October 31
October 31, 2022 - 4:00pm to 4:30pm

[View all upcoming meetings](#)

Research > The Problems

Goals

Brookline's website is bland and does not indicate the type of community that exists within the town. This redesign will strive to

Remove Redundancy

Establish where there is multiplicities in the content and condense them. Cut down on unnecessary information.

Add Personality

Create a bold text hierarchy that compliments imagery of the school systems and families.

Create Community

Establish a clear calendar that condenses community-related events and add a featured events section.

Research > Comparative Analysis

Travel to San Francisco

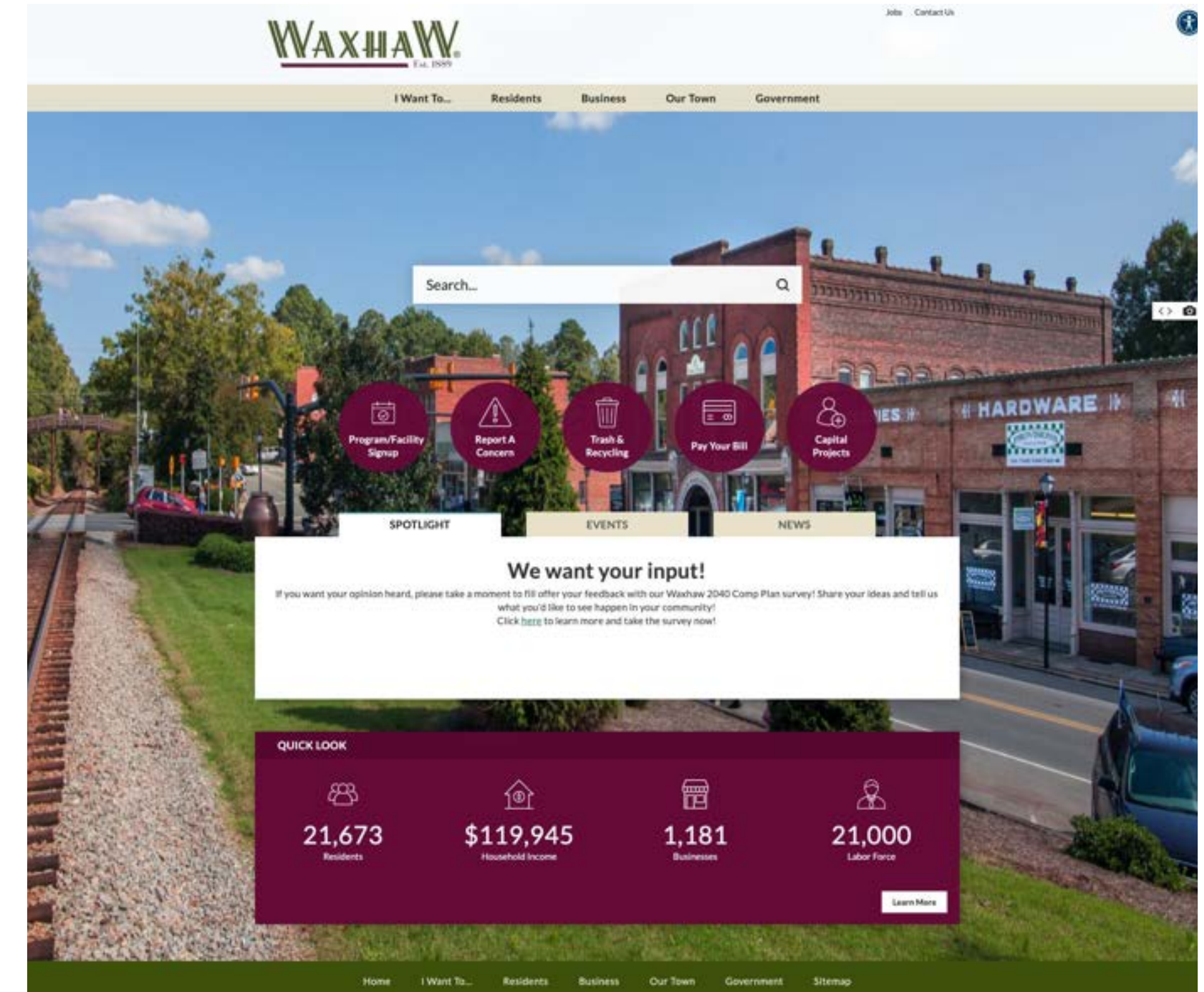
1. San Francisco's website incorporates tourism-based elements that display the town's importance.
2. The photos emphasize the beauty of the area and the events that are going on.
3. There is unique branding (color, shape, clear visual hierarchy) and concise navigational layout.



Research > Comparative Analysis

Town of Waxhaw

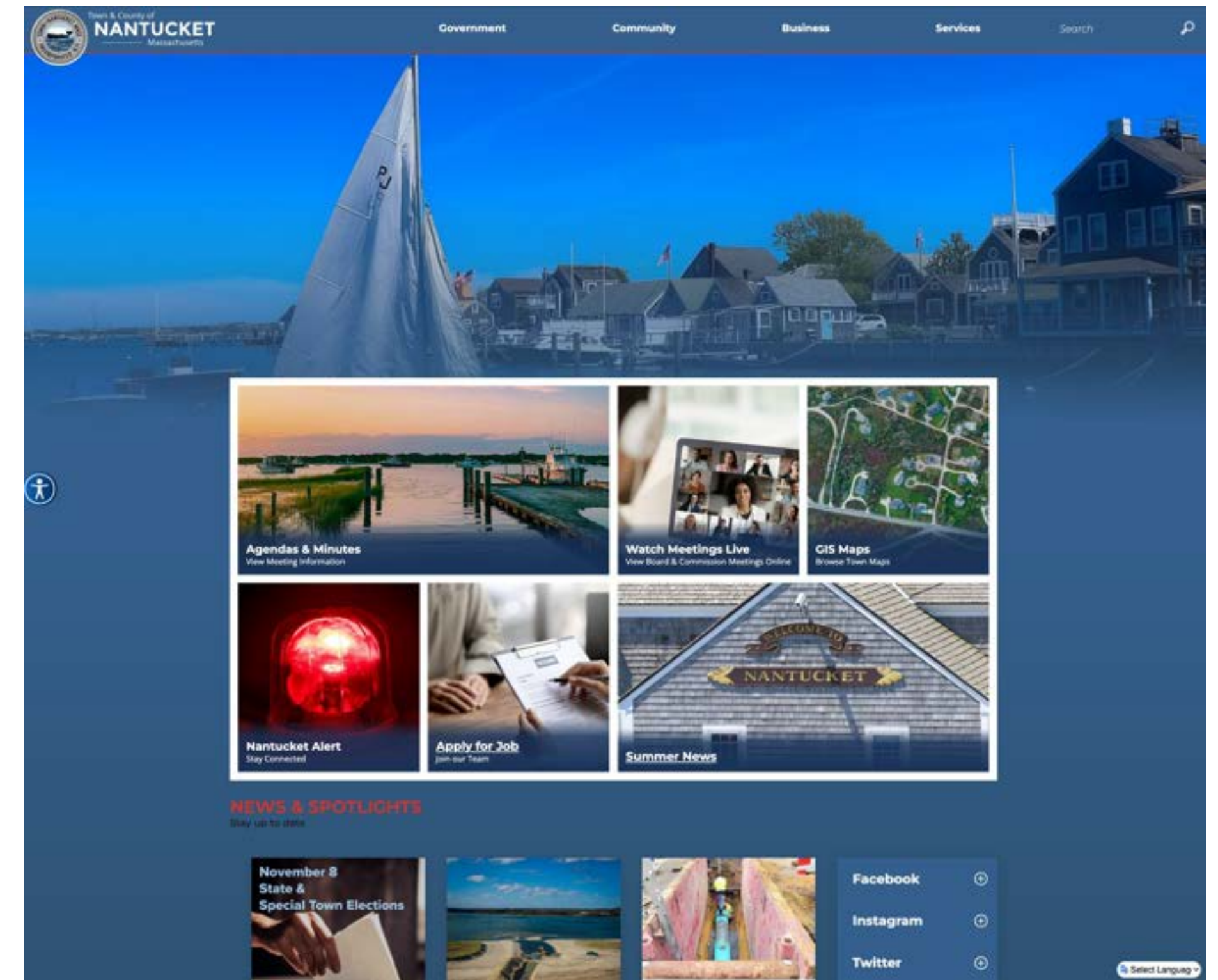
1. The micro-animations adds characters to the website and makes it more dynamic.
2. There is a clear hierarchy of information and organization.
3. All widgets have a purpose and avoid redundancies.
4. The quick look section is allows for quick digestion of town-related statistics.



Research > Comparative Analysis

Town & County of Nantucket

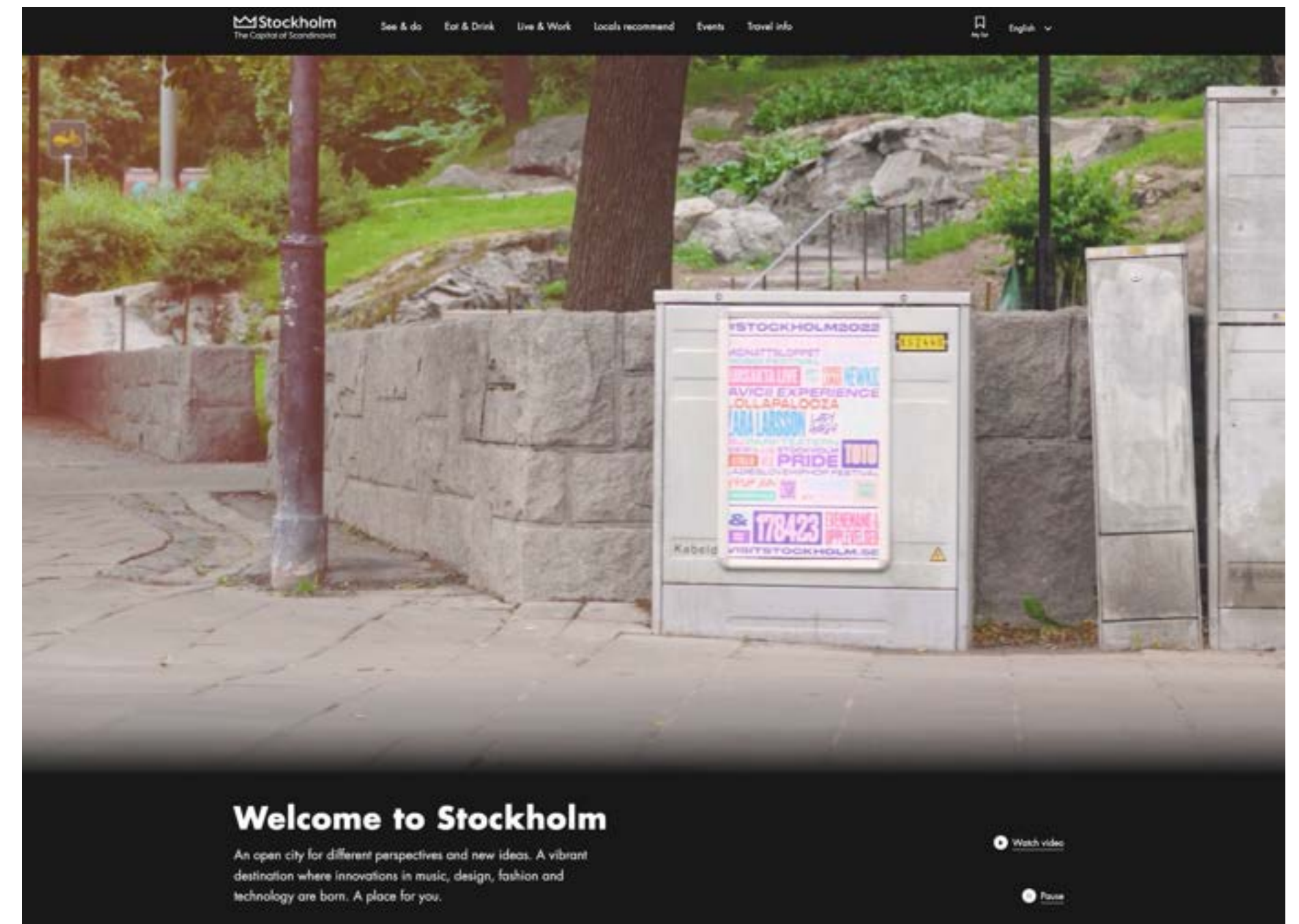
1. The photography and colors compliment each other.
2. The hierarchy of the navigation is clear and concise.
3. Town meeting information is present but not dominating the entire landing page of the website.
4. There is a clear separation between the resident and visitors sections.



Research > Comparative Analysis

Visit Stockholm

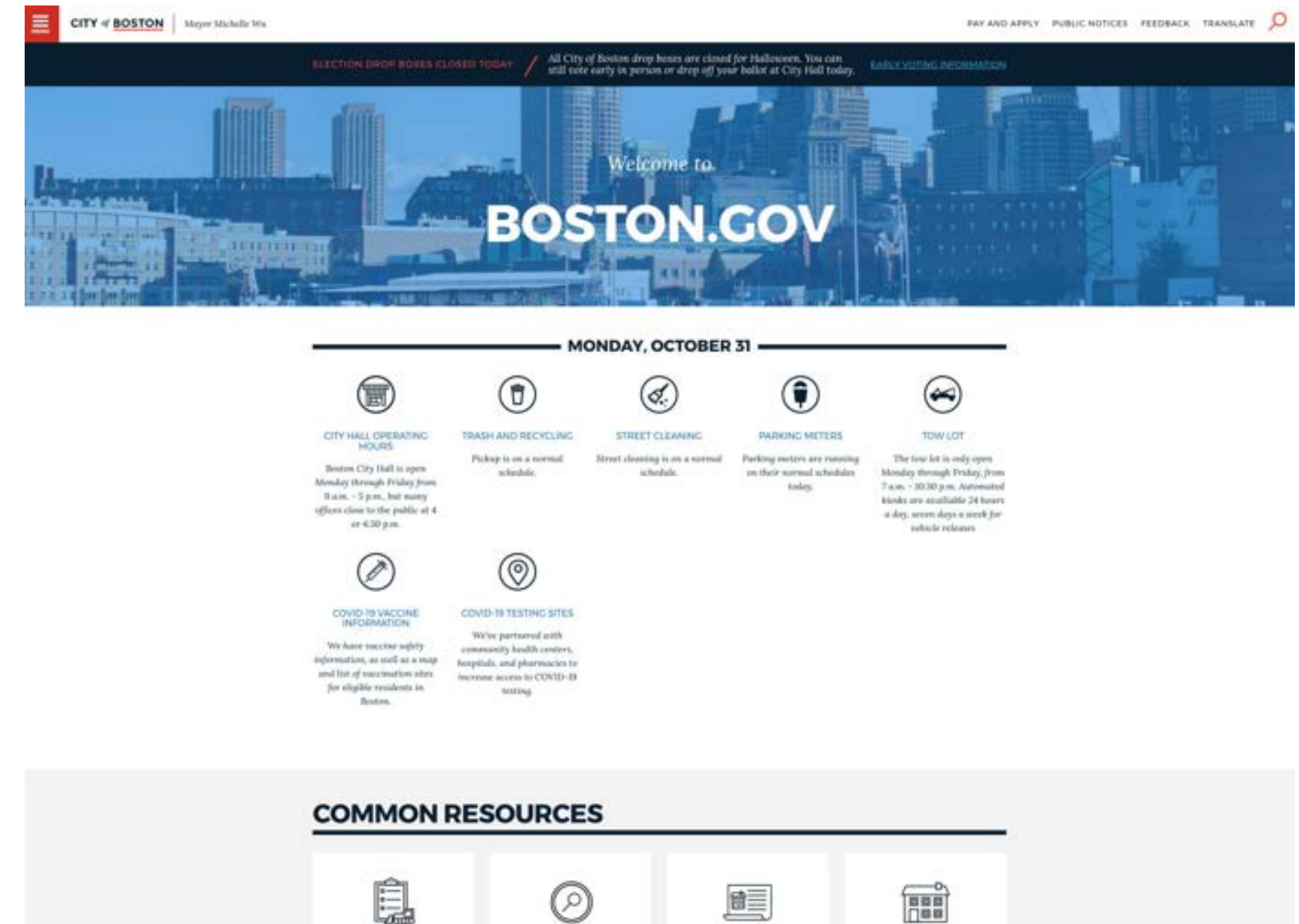
1. The imagery and video creates visual interest on the landing page and headers.
2. The navigation is clear and concise.
3. The visual hierarchy, including with text, is easy to identify and skim through.
4. The micro-animations add character to the website and make it more dynamic.



Research > Comparative Analysis

City of Boston

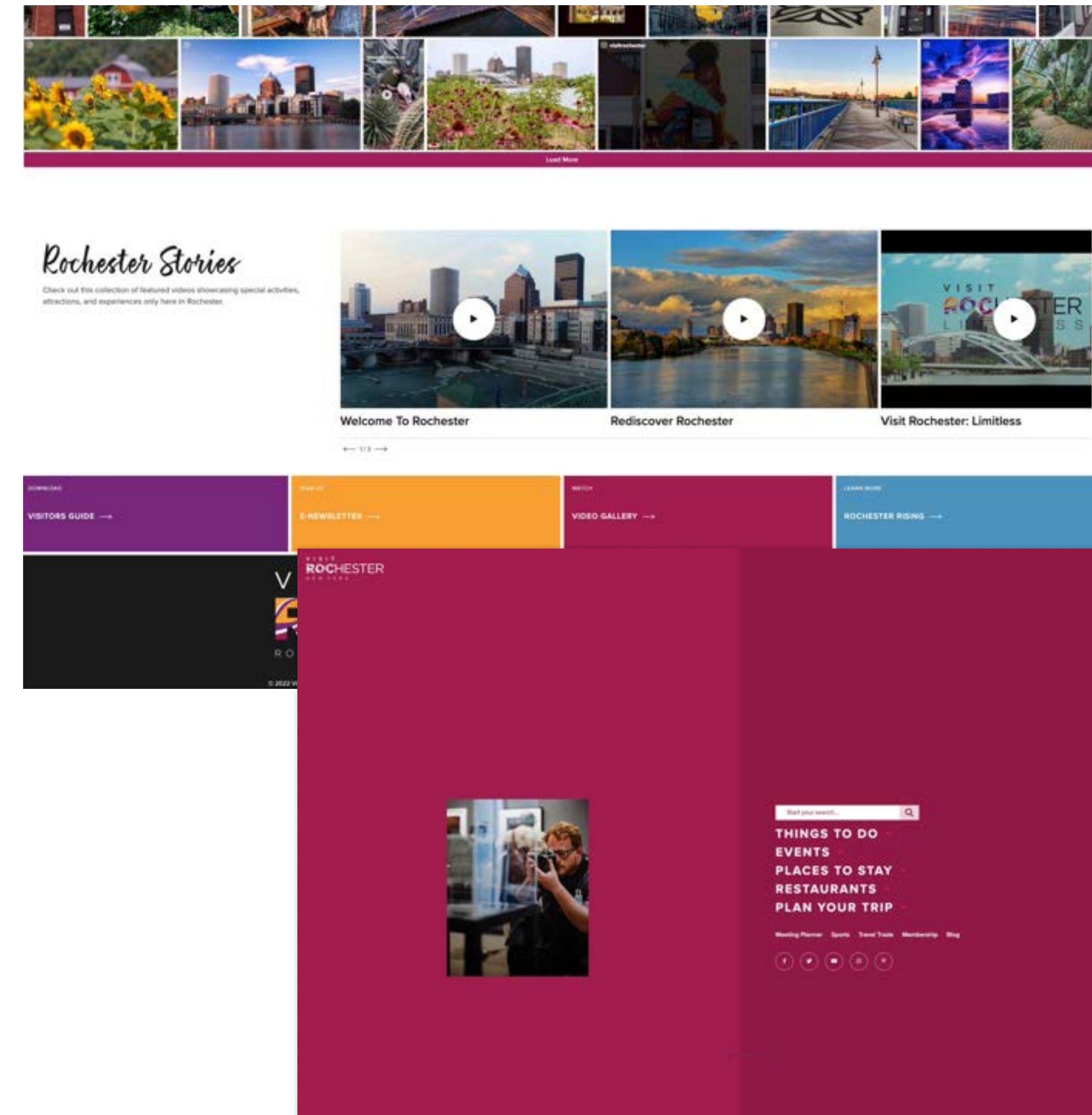
1. There is concise navigation that is easy to digest.
2. There is unique branding and use of color throughout the website. The bold color paired with the greyscale creates a clear color-based hierarchy.
3. The upcoming events are easy-to-find and comprehend.



Research > Comparative Analysis

Visit Rochester

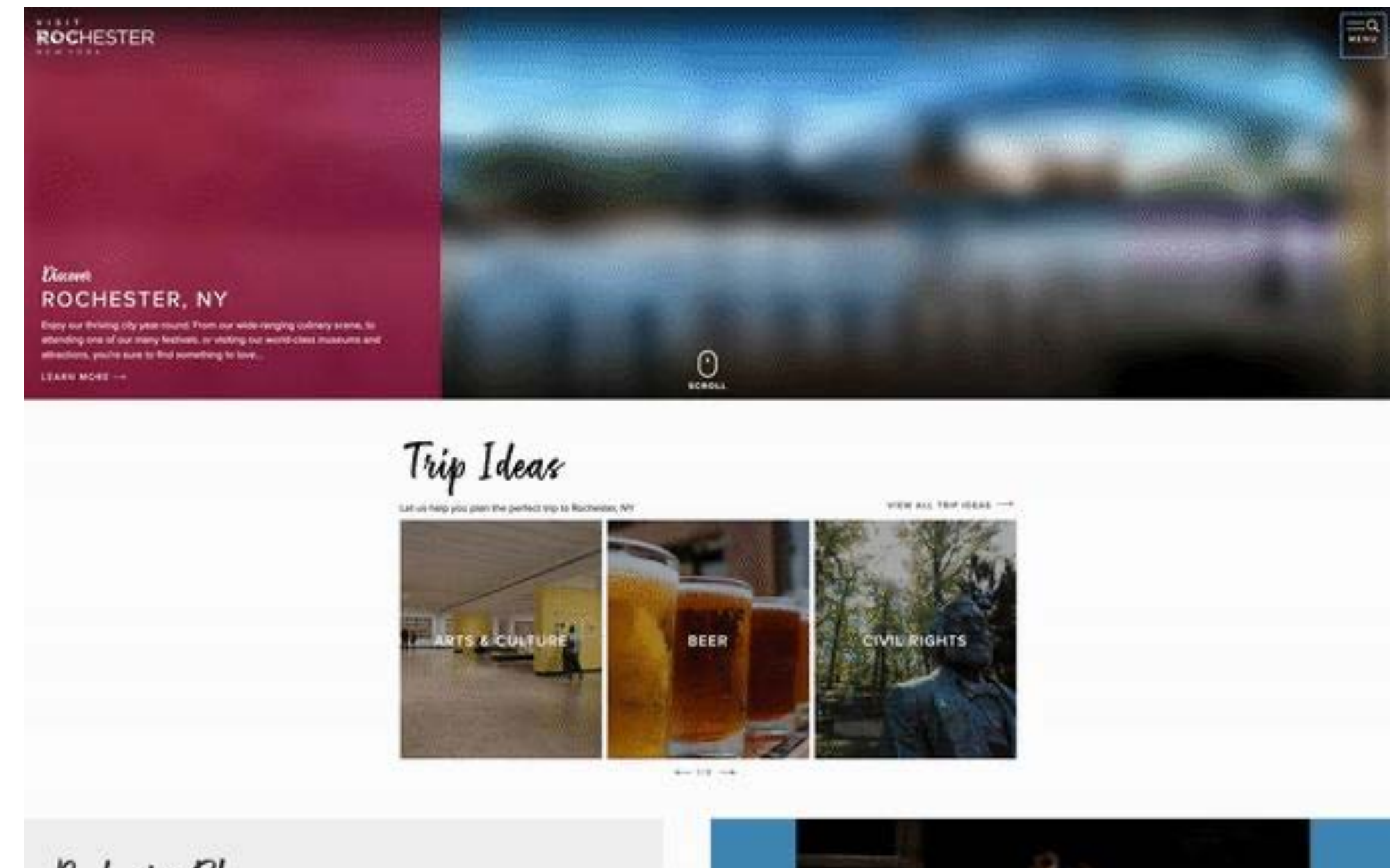
1. There are bold color combinations to add personality to the website.
2. It blends the living of Rochester and tourism through the blog, the pictures, the event features, etc.
3. There is quick-to-comprehend iconography for the hamburger menu.



Research > Patterns

Micro-animations

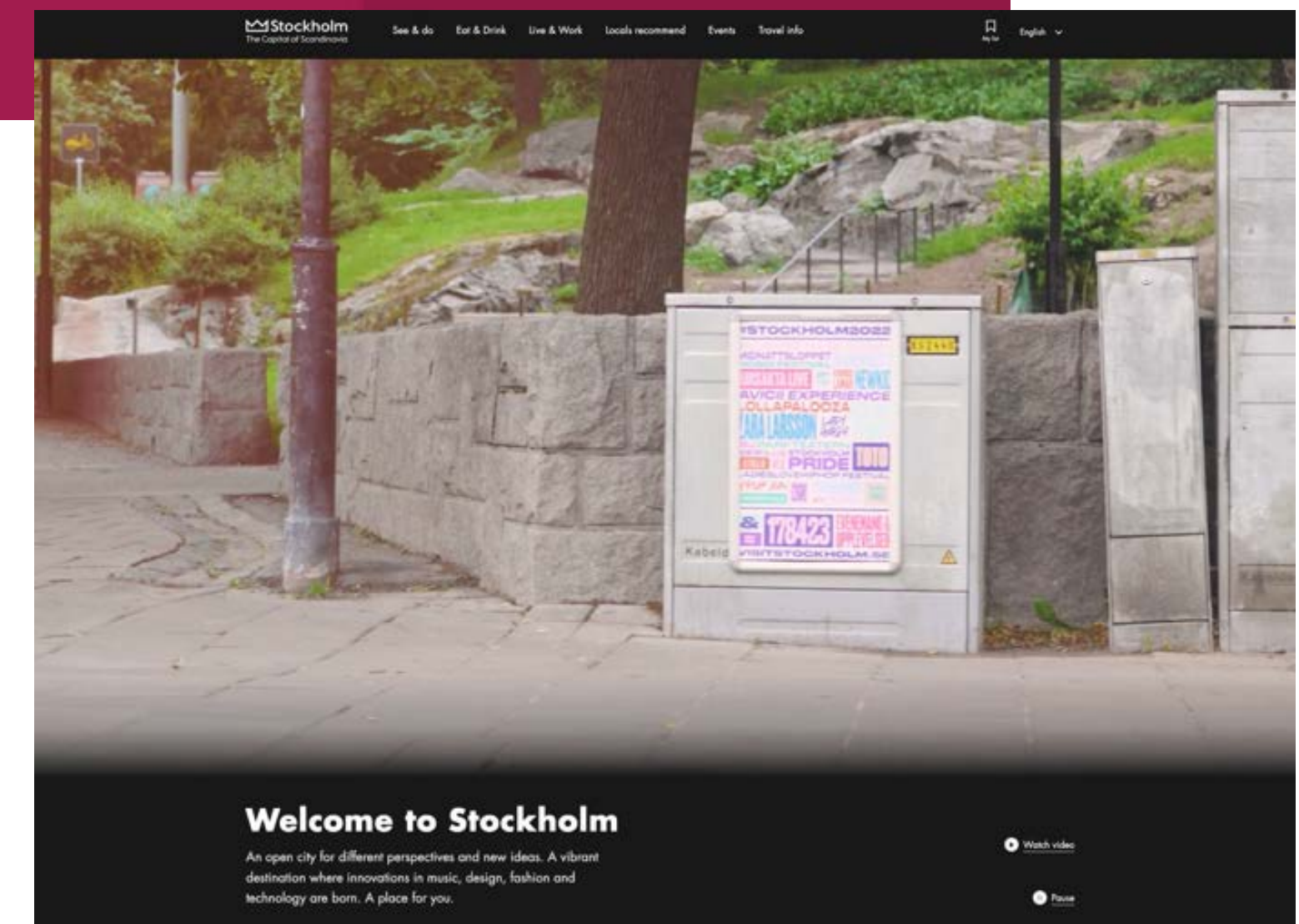
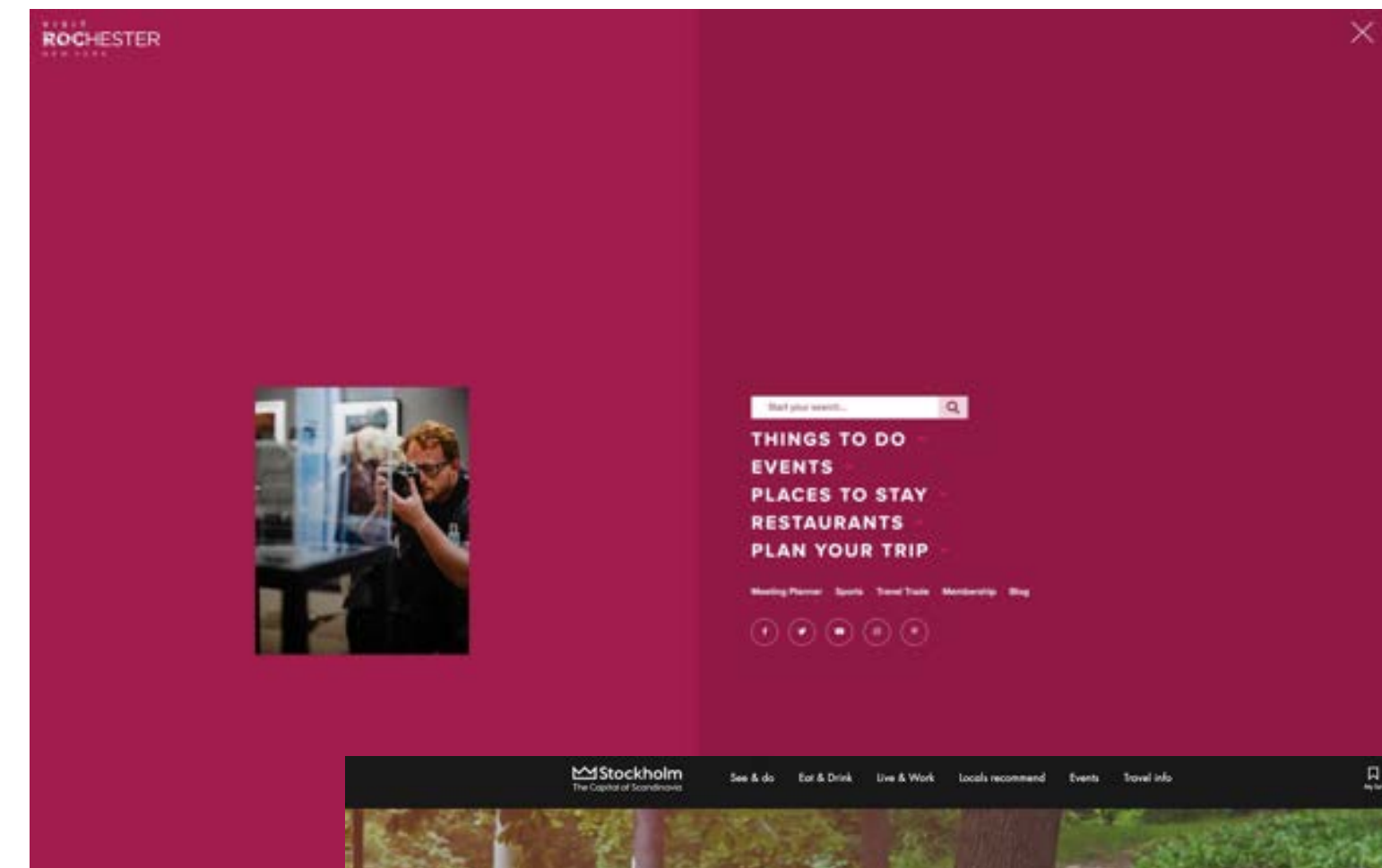
1. These add character to these towns' websites and emphasize the personality portrayed through their branding.
2. Often, the micro-animations appear when the user interacts with elements like hovering over a button.



Research > Patterns

Concise Navigation

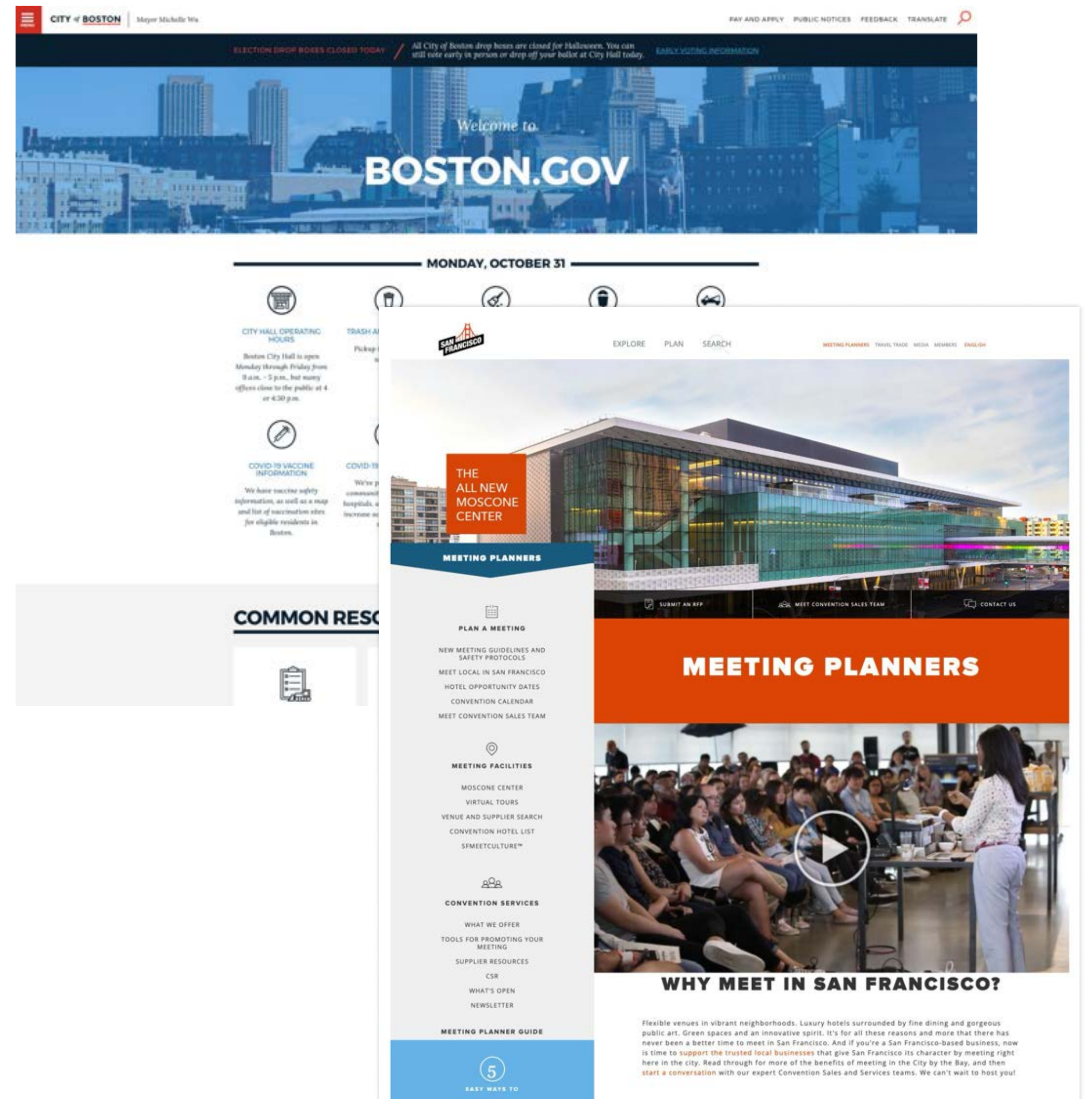
1. These websites don't vary drastically from the existing mental models of what navigation typically looks like. Most of them have the logo on the top left of the navigation and the contents of the navigation to the right.
2. Rochester NY's website is where this varies, with the hamburger being the default form of the navigation, even in desktop mode.



Research > Patterns

Bold, but Limited Colors

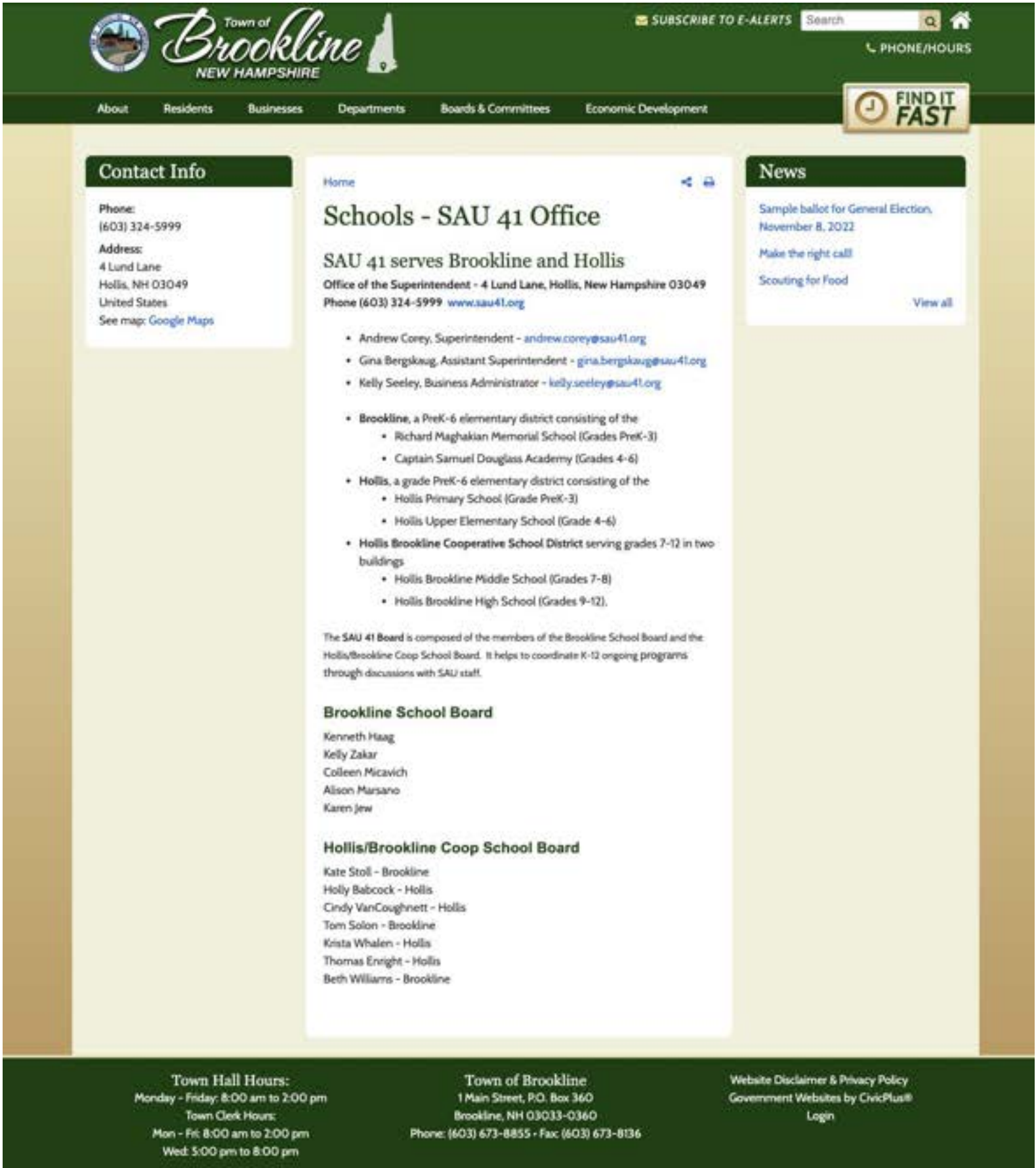
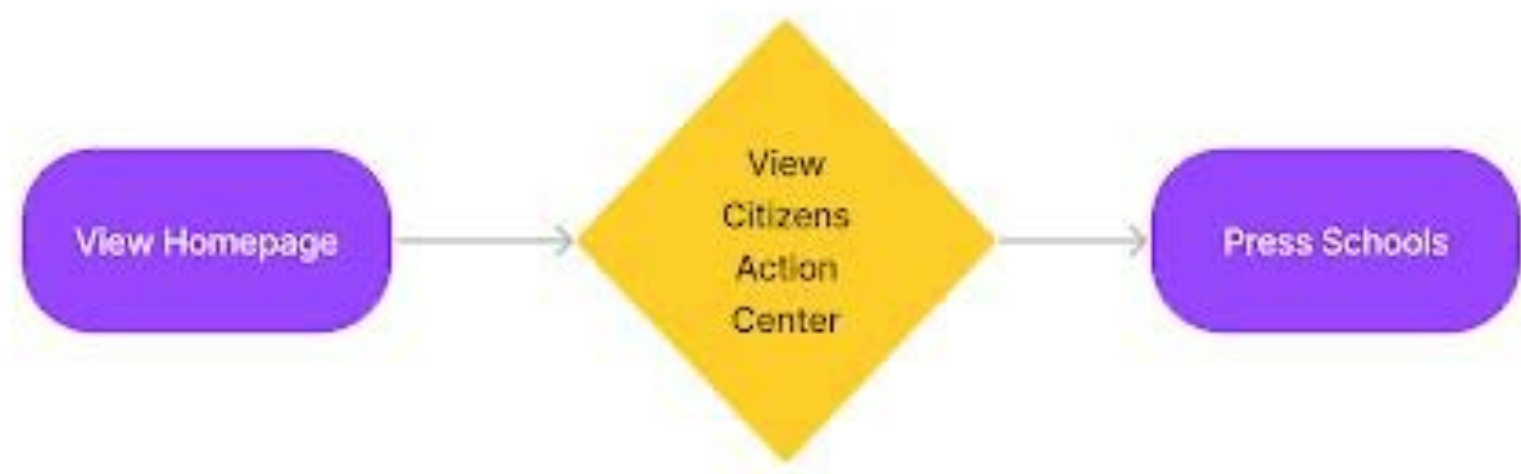
1. All of the references effectively use color to add personality to their websites. This personality makes them feel more unique and they vary significantly from the other websites that are out there.



Research > User Flow

Current Flow

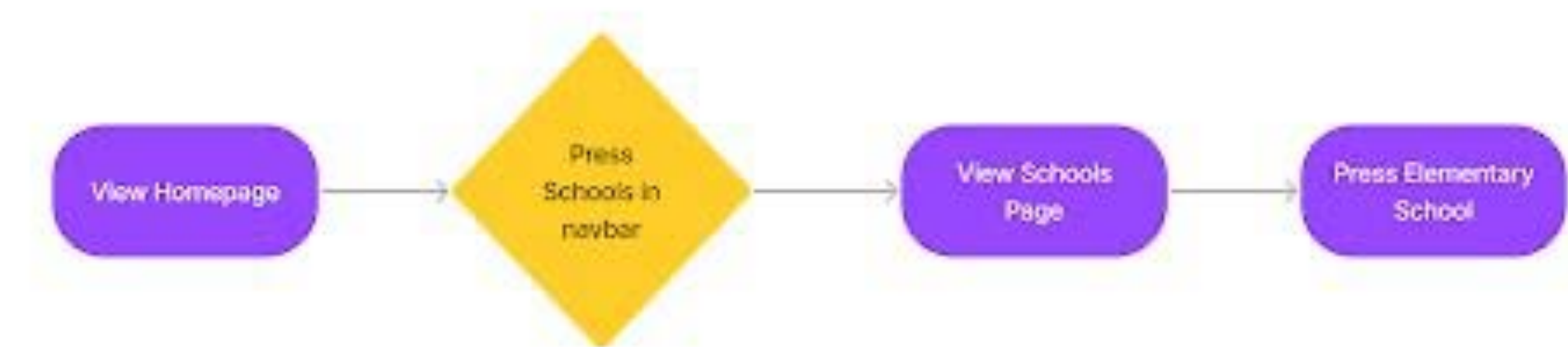
Many Brookline residents move to the town for the school system. The current user-flow makes it difficult to find information about the schools.



Research > User Flow

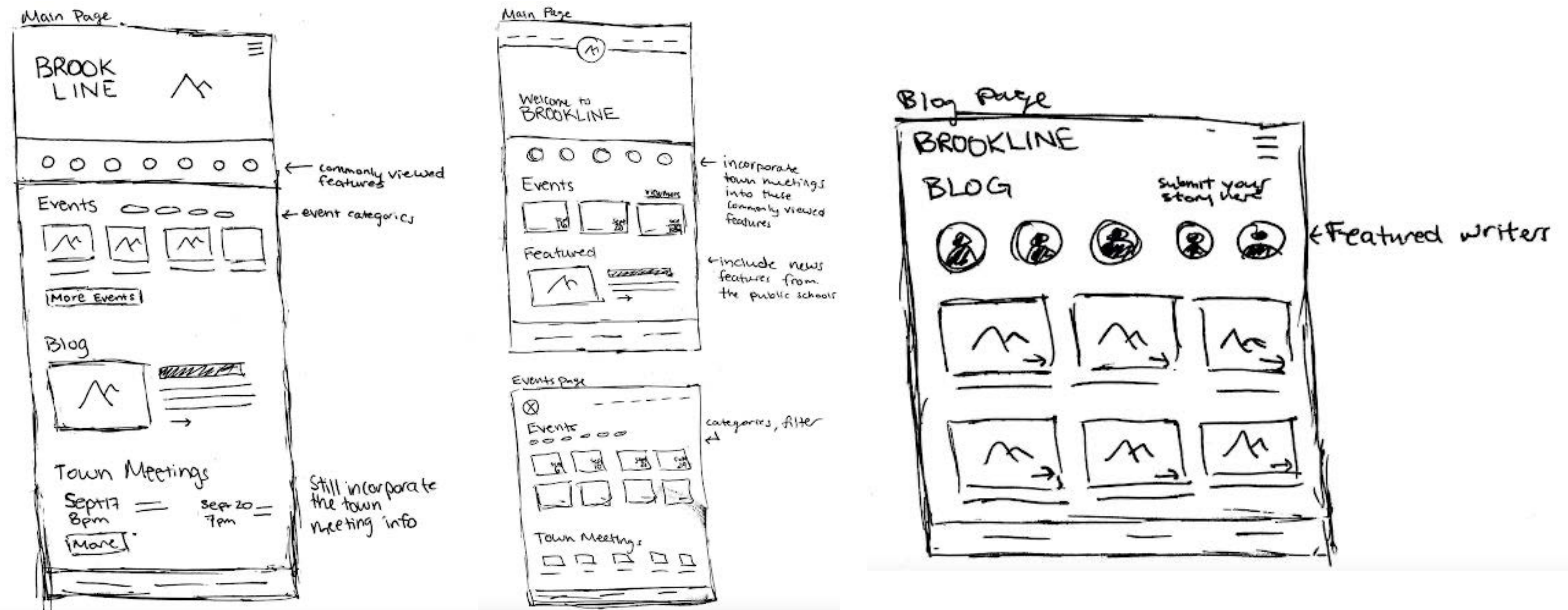
Updated Flow

The revision to this flow will not only be more intuitive, but there will be further opportunities to expand upon the individual schools and learn more.



Process > Ideation

Sketches



Process > Wireframes

Home



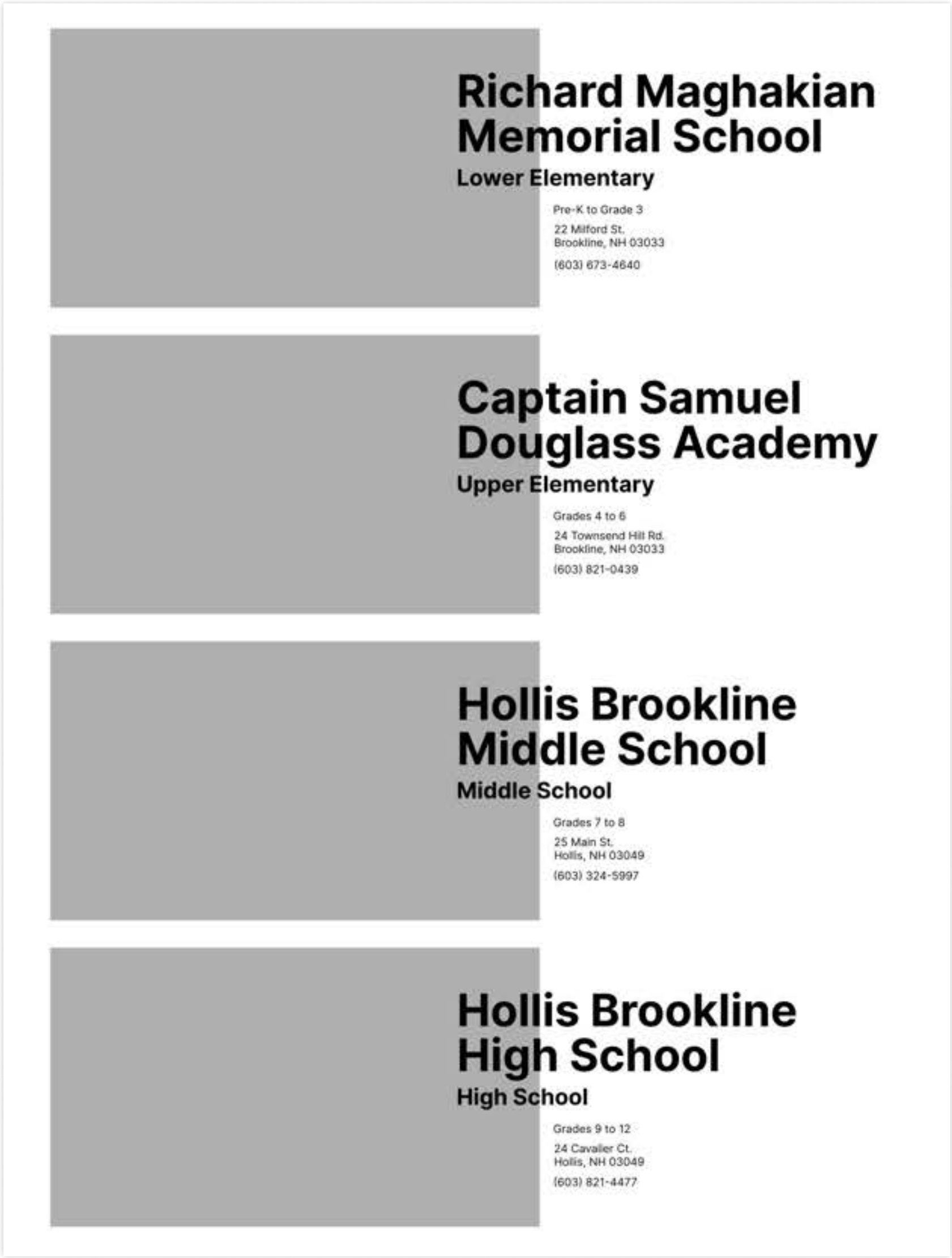
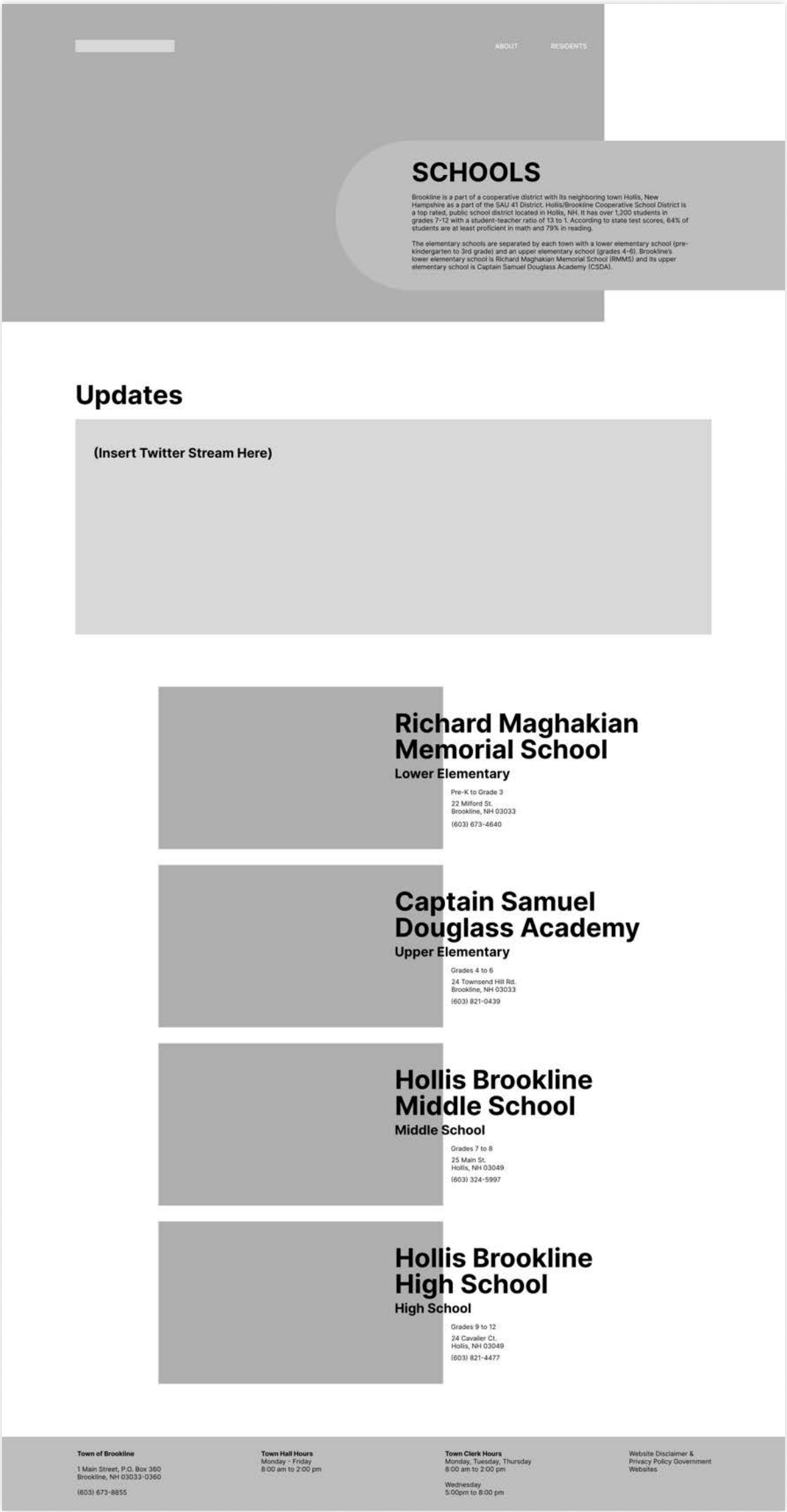
Megan Garcia



Redesigning the Town of Brookline

Process > Wireframes

Schools



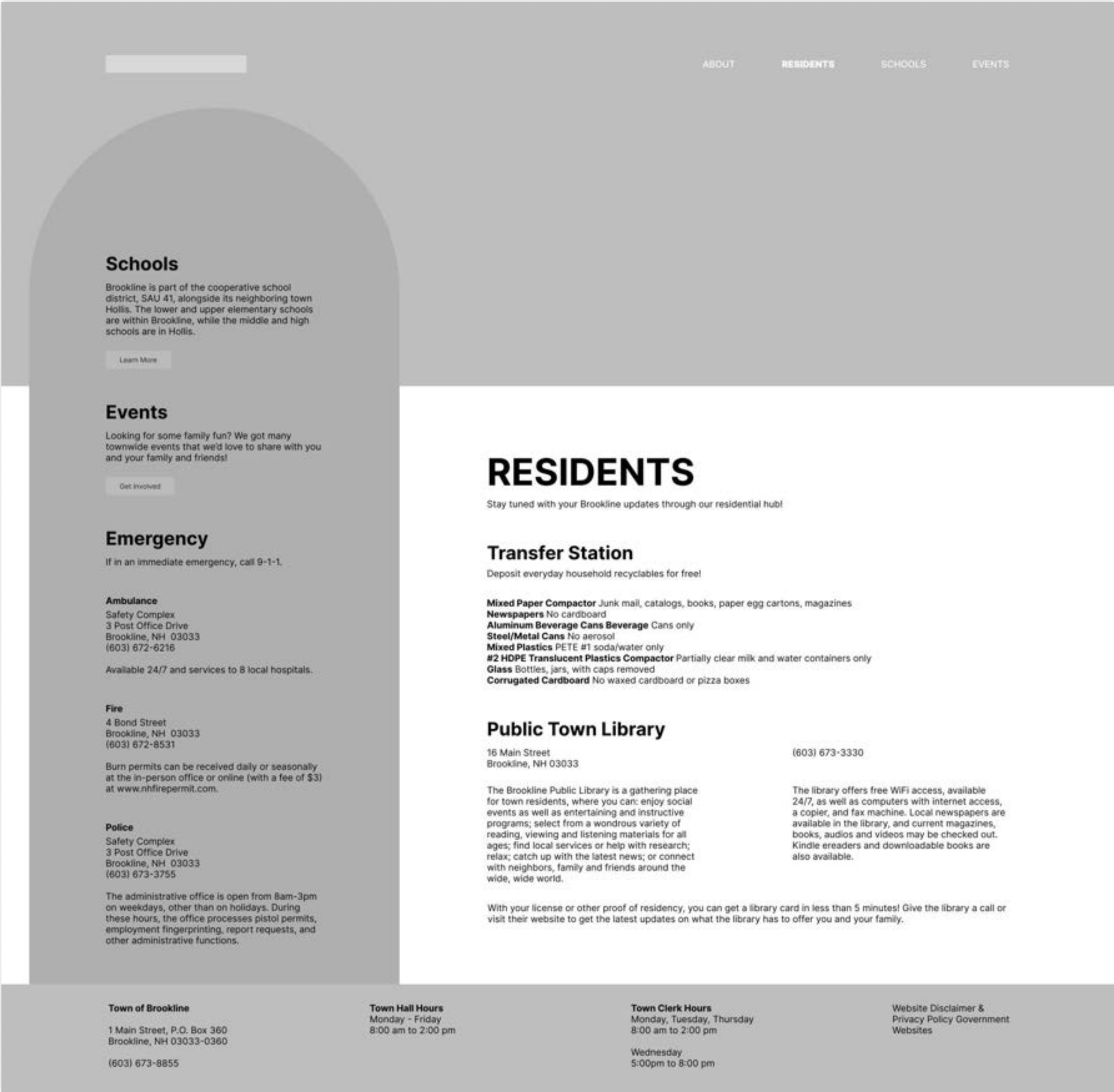
Process > Wireframes

About



Process > Wireframes

Residents



Process > Wireframes

Events



Process > Exploration

Moodboard 1

Active In Nature

Display natural beauty of the community through an emphasis on the outdoors and local active/athletic activities and events.

Fresh

Subtle

Movement

Calm

Gentle

Harmony



Process > Exploration

Moodboard 2

Color Block Funk

Through bold and asymmetrical color blocking, highlight the community's family-friendly and playful atmosphere and events.

Playful

Bold

Vibrant

Asymmetrical

Funky

Exciting



Process > Exploration

Applied Mood Board 1

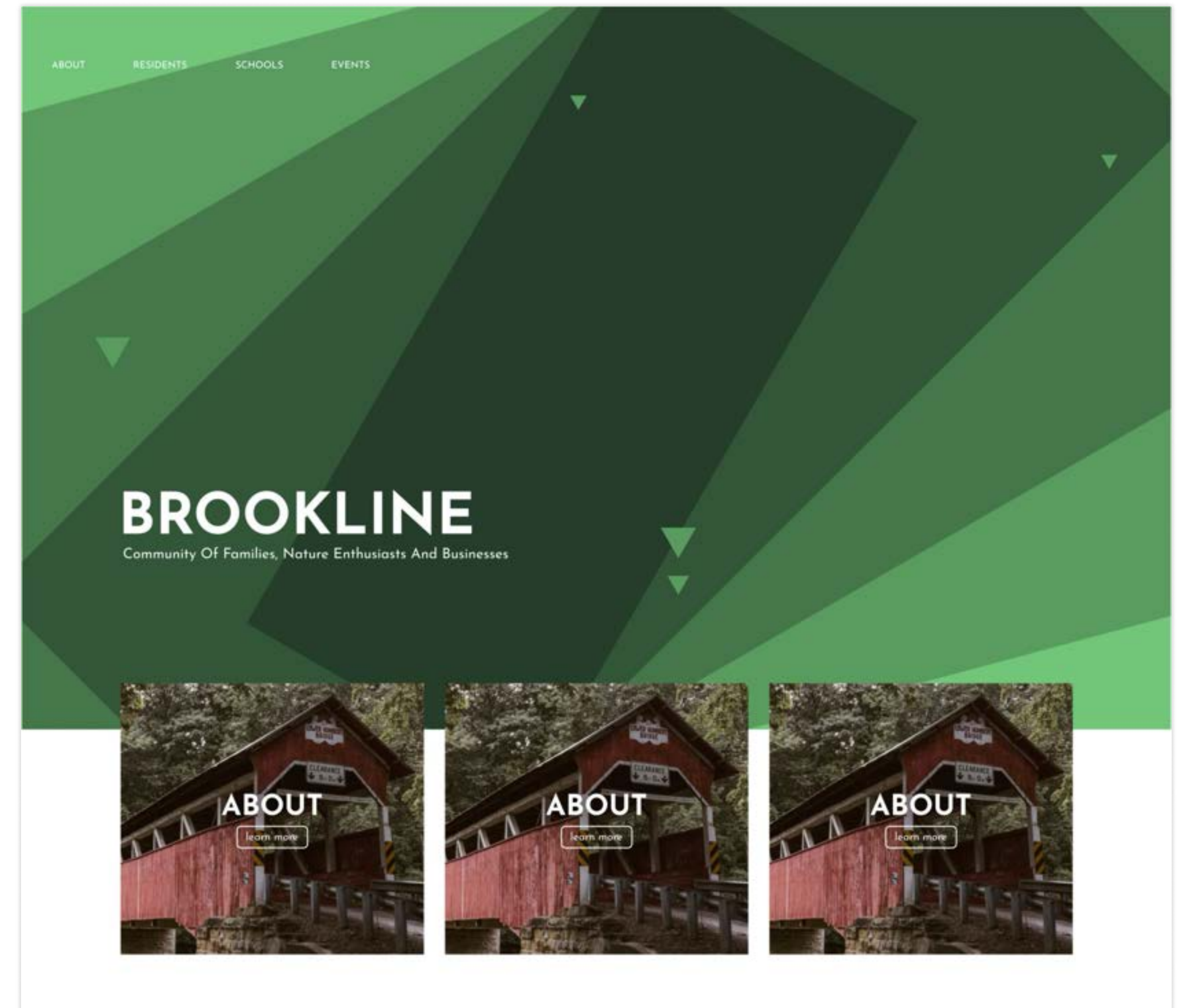
This nature-inspired exploration of the home page follows the *Active In Nature* mood board. This direction blends the imagery of active culture and nature with the repetition of the circles to create a uniform sense of continuity and highlight the town's plentiful outdoor opportunities.



Process > Exploration

Applied Mood Board 2

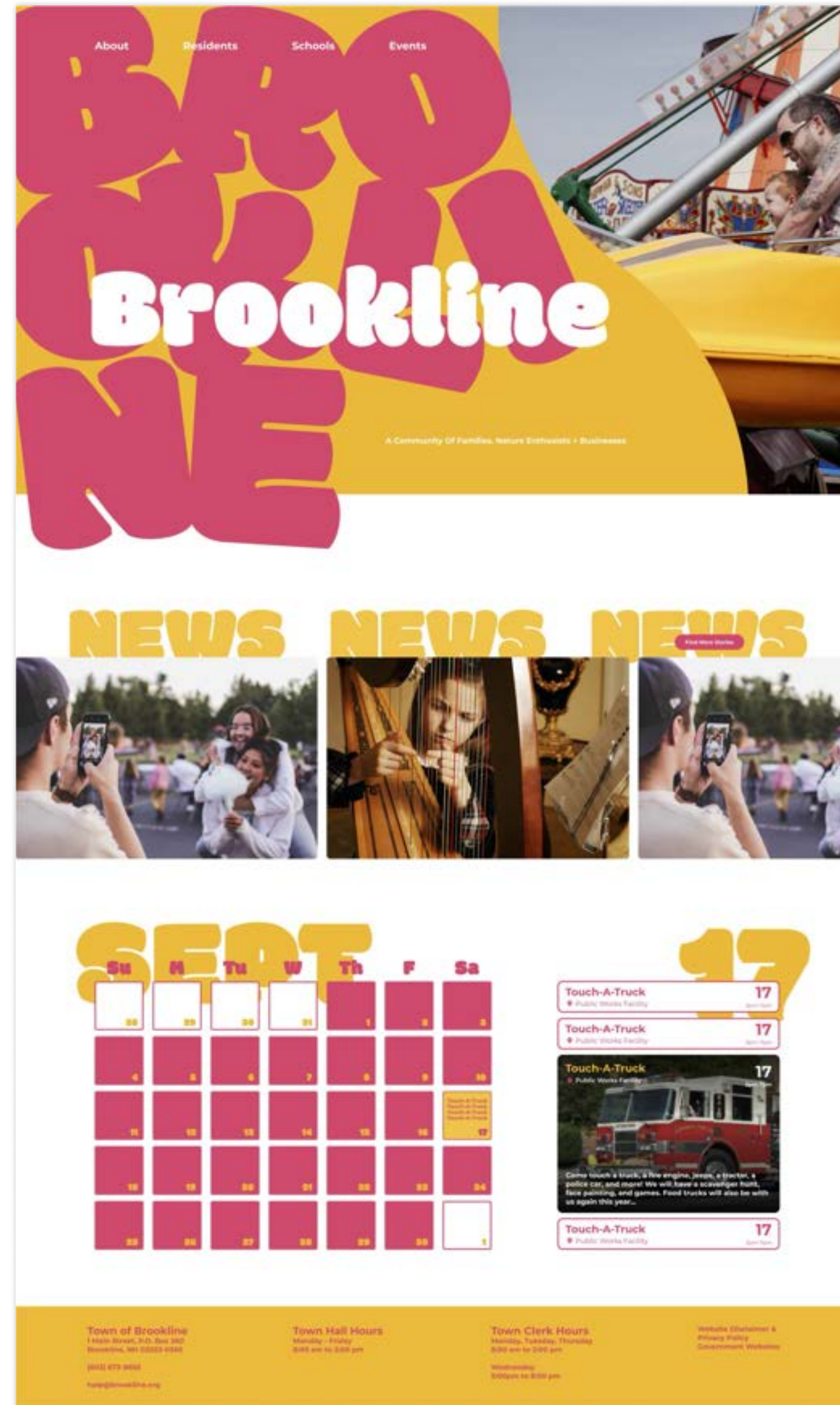
For this geometric direction, it is based on the *Color Block Funk* mood board. With the moving, geometric shapes, the website gears itself towards a fun, playful audience that directly correlates with the youthful families that move to Brookline for its school systems.



Almost There...

After putting together those two mood boards, I saw how stale they were in comparison to the town's atmosphere. I decided to lean more into the *Color Block Funk* mood board with this new iteration.

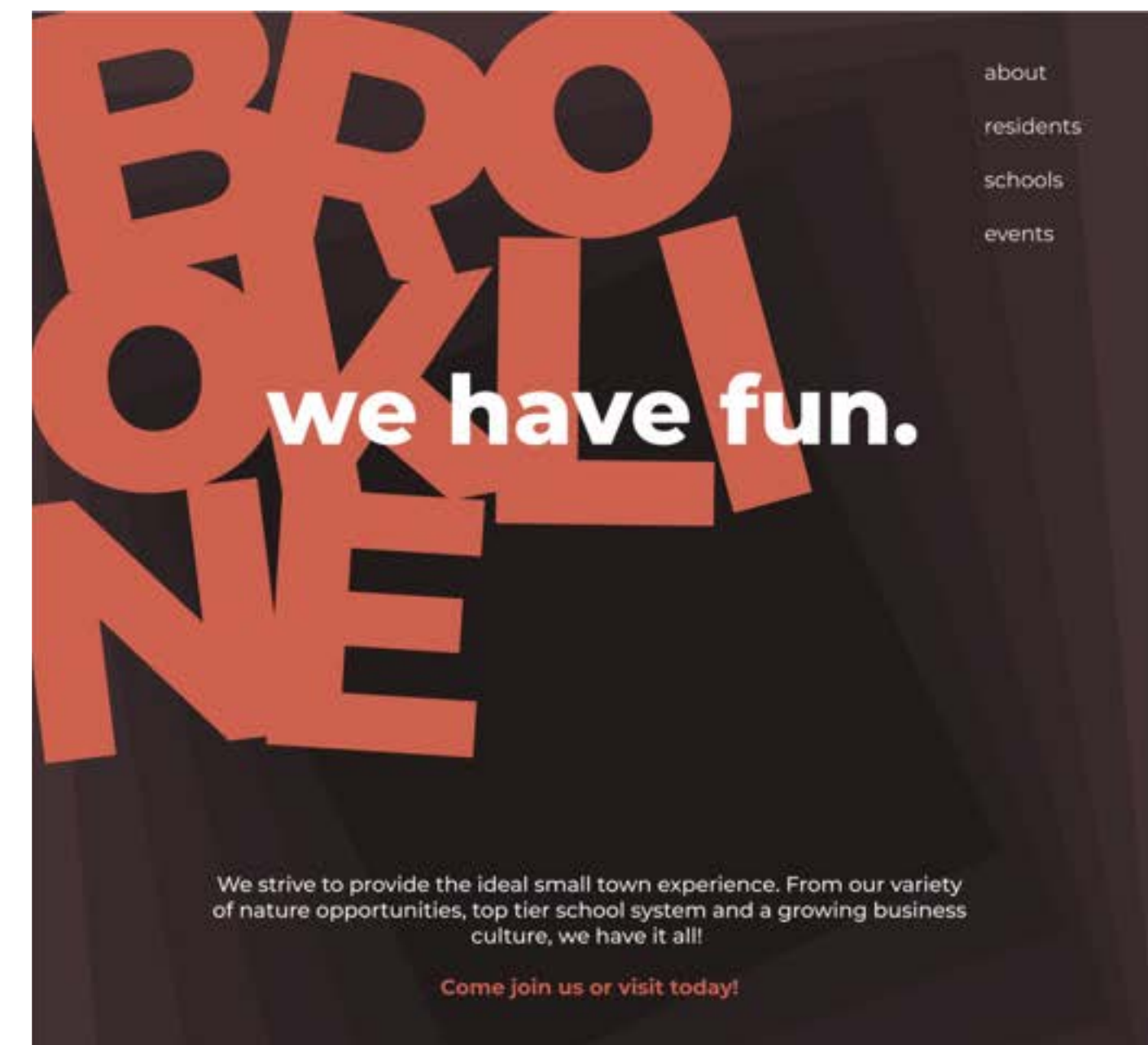
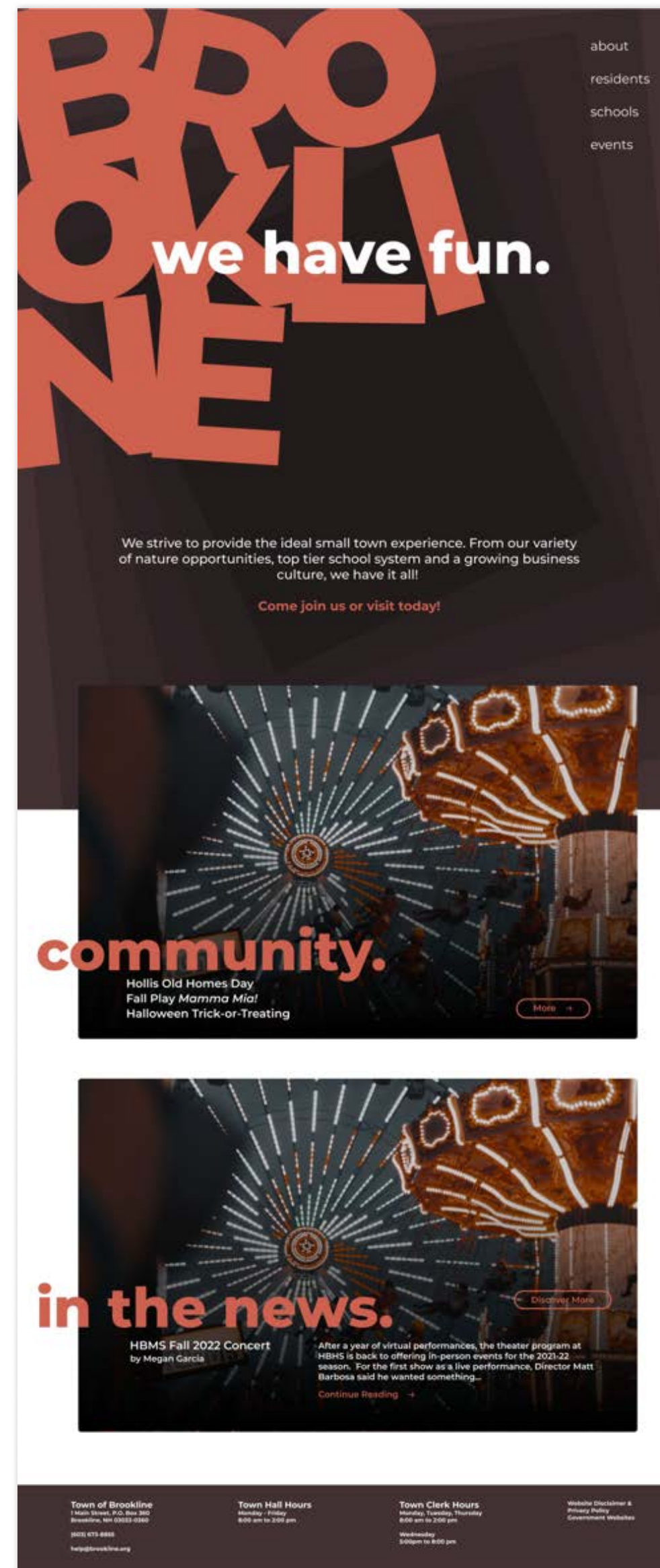
Still, this did not capture the town's energy. I needed to blend the natural aesthetic with this funky asymmetric implementation.



Process > Exploration

We Made It!

Finally! This final iteration of the home page combined the asymmetrical elements from *Color Block Funk*, while also bringing in the more muted color palette and bold sans serif font of the *Active In Nature*. This combination balanced out so that the website could appeal to a wider age range, while still geared towards the fun side of Brookline and younger demographic.



Process > Final Designs

Home



Megan Garcia



Redesigning the Town of Brookline

Process > Final Designs

About

BROOKLINE

about

residents

schools

events

about

Chartered on March 30, 1769 as the town of “Raby”, Brookline has been one of the fastest growing towns in the state over the past 25 years. In 1960, Brookline’s population stood at 795 and recently reached 5,000.

Located in eastern Hillsborough county, Brookline has many features of its rural past while benefiting from close proximity to the cities of Milford and Nashua. Brookline is about thirty minutes from Manchester, NH and one hour from Boston.

nature fun

Lake Potanipo

Lake PotanipoAndres Institute of ArtBeaver Brook Association

One hundred years ago, the shores of Lake Potanipo housed the “largest ice house under one roof in the world” with tens of thousands of tons of ice cut from the lake each year and shipped by rail to Cambridge and Somerville, Massachusetts. Though the railroad was dismantled in the 1940s, its former railbed now provides miles of recreational trails. Lake Potanipo provides year around benefits to residents and visitors, including swimming, boating, ice fishing, snowmobiling and the town’s annual fireworks display.

HISTORY

Originally, Brookline was established as a part of West Hollis by the 1637 Dursstable grant. The town continued to grow as settlers moved to the town when the Massachusetts-New Hampshire border was established in 1741. The town was granted the name Raby in 1769 by Governor John Wentworth and was later renamed to Brookline in 1796 by the New Hampshire legislature.

Brookline began to quickly grow with the establishment of the Fresh Pond Ice Company in 1890. The ice from Lake Potanipo was frequently harvested during the winter season and shipped to Boston, Massachusetts, which is now about an hour drive in the modern world. During the company’s peak, there were 250 employees and it would annually harvest 100,000 tons of ice from 13 ice houses.

The business was so successful that The Brookline and Pepperell Railroad was created on September 8, 1890 just to facilitate the transportation of ice to Boston, Massachusetts.

Nowadays, none of the infrastructure of the Fresh Pond Ice Company remains, but the railroad is still around. The Brookline and Pepperell Railroad is used less frequently now than it was when the ice company was in business, but it currently is used primarily for transportation of goods across Maine, New Hampshire, and Massachusetts.

Chrysanthi’s

Chrysanthi’sAlamo BBQJuanita’sVal’s Pizza & SubsSundae Drive

Chrysanthi’s has been a Brookline staple since 2006. Chrysanthi’s is a blend of Greek, Italian and American cuisine. It is a cozy, sit down restaurant with locally sourced, in-season produce from Brookdale Farms in Hollis, NH and fresh seafood, delivered from Ipswich, Massachusetts. They primarily serve lunch and dinner throughout the week, excluding Sundays. Over the past decade, they have also received a variety of awards, with the most notable being the 2012 Best Takeout of the Souhagan Region.

food

Town of Brookline

1000 North Street, 2nd Floor
Brookline, NH 03005-0302
603.873.4800
brookline.nh.gov

Town Hall Hours

Monday-Friday
8:00am to 5:00pm

Town Clerk Hours

Monday, Tuesday, Thursday
8:00am to 5:00pm
Wednesday
10:00am to 4:00pm

Website: Brookline’s
Privacy Policy
Government Websites

BROOKLINE

about

residents

schools

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about

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Process > Final Designs

Schools



Process > Final Designs

Residents



Process > Final Designs

Events



Process > Prototyping

Home

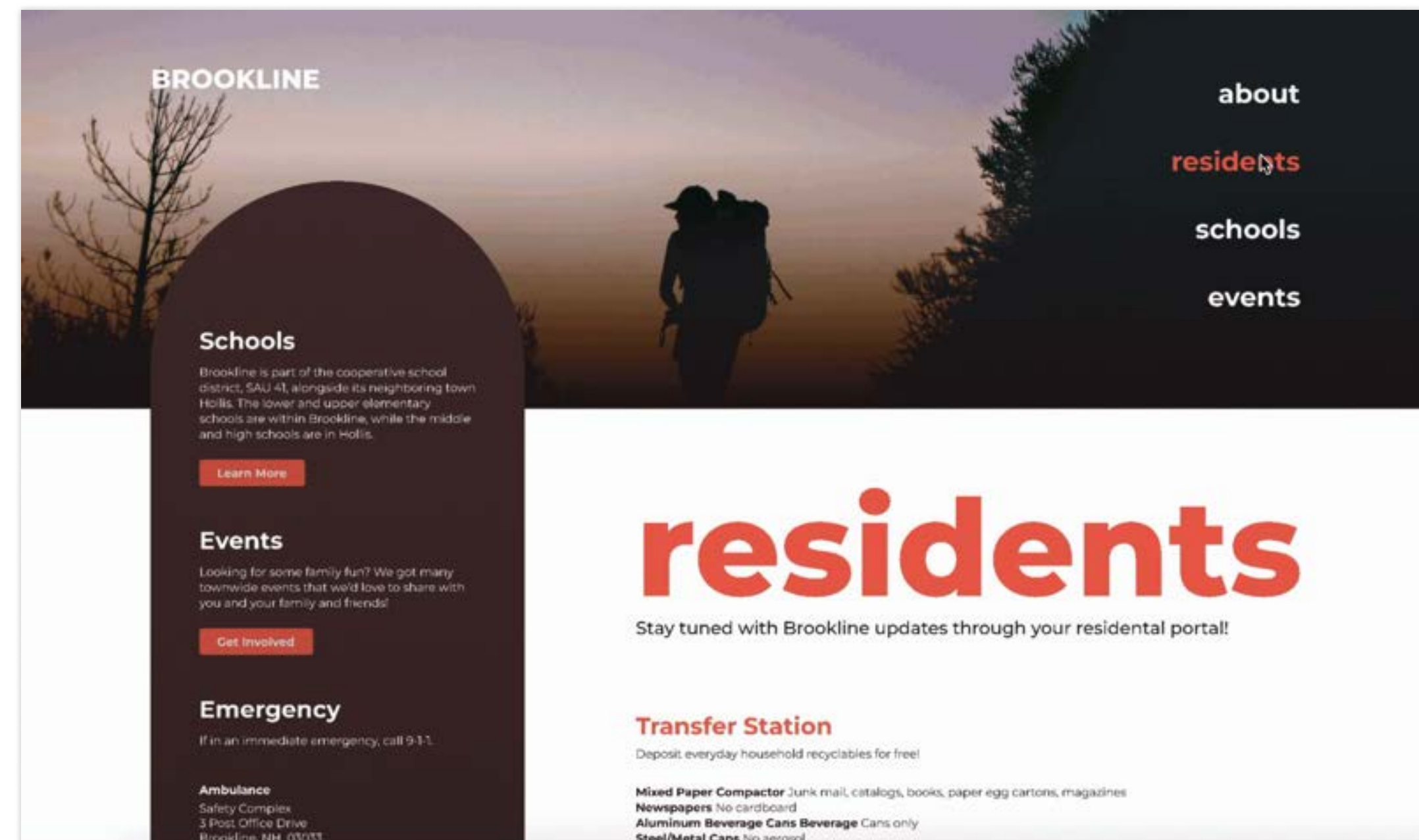
Background rectangles rock back and forth to add some playful micro-animations to the above the fold section.



Process > Prototyping

Residents

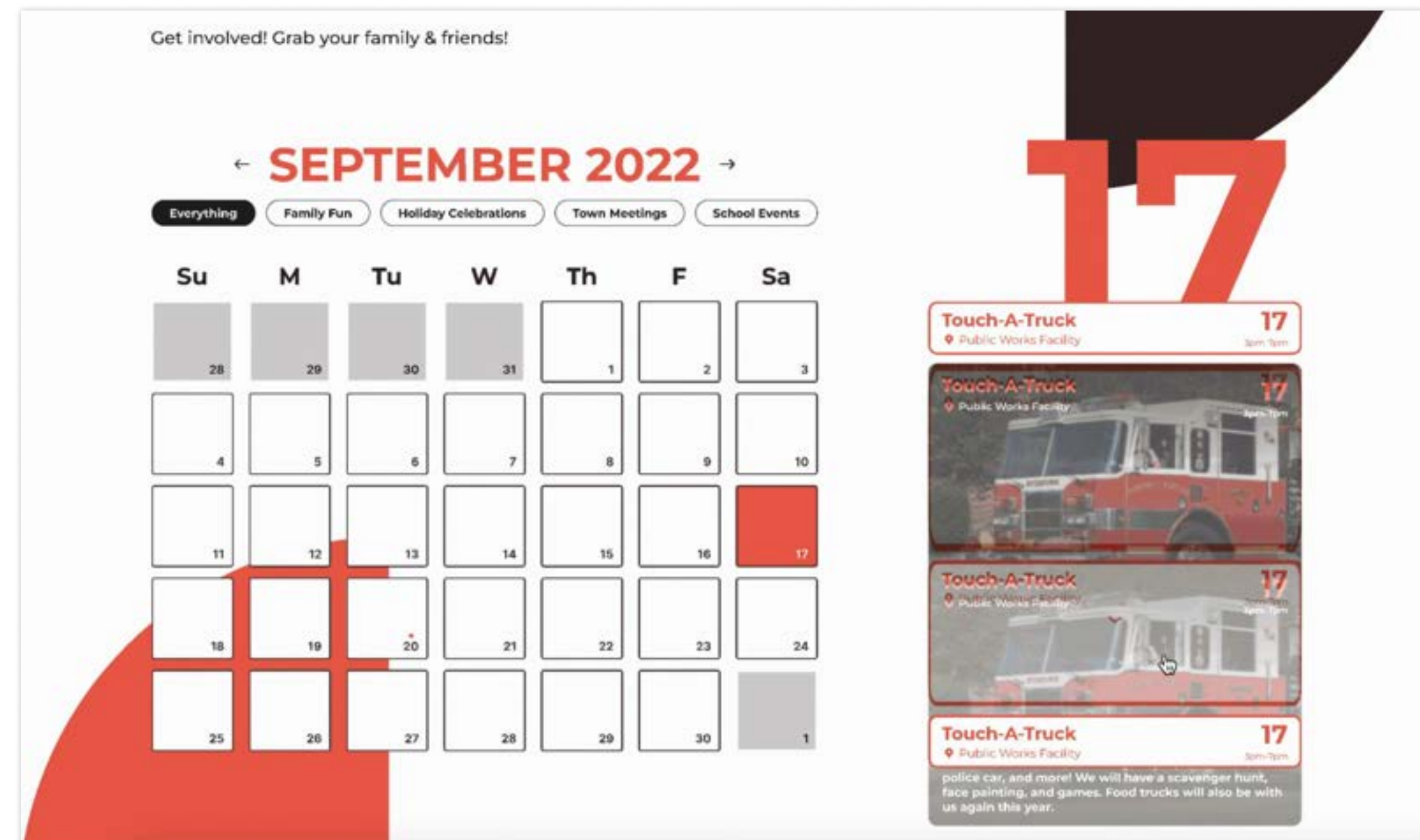
The rounded, dark brown rectangle bounces into the frame as the user scrolls down the screen.



Process > Prototyping

Events

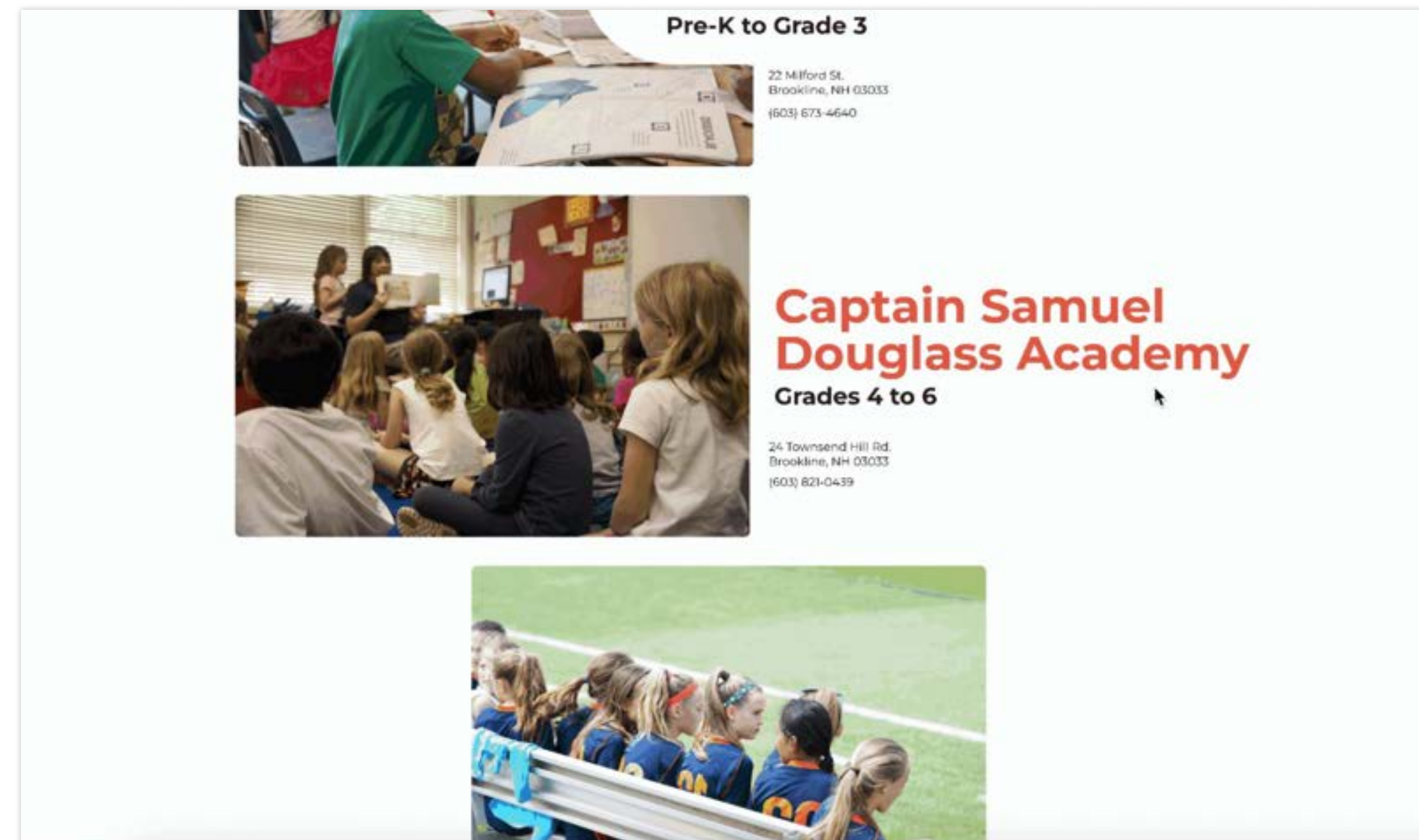
The quarter circles slide into the frame to add a sense of depth to the website. The calendar also features micro-animations to help guide the user through the content.



Process > Prototyping

Schools

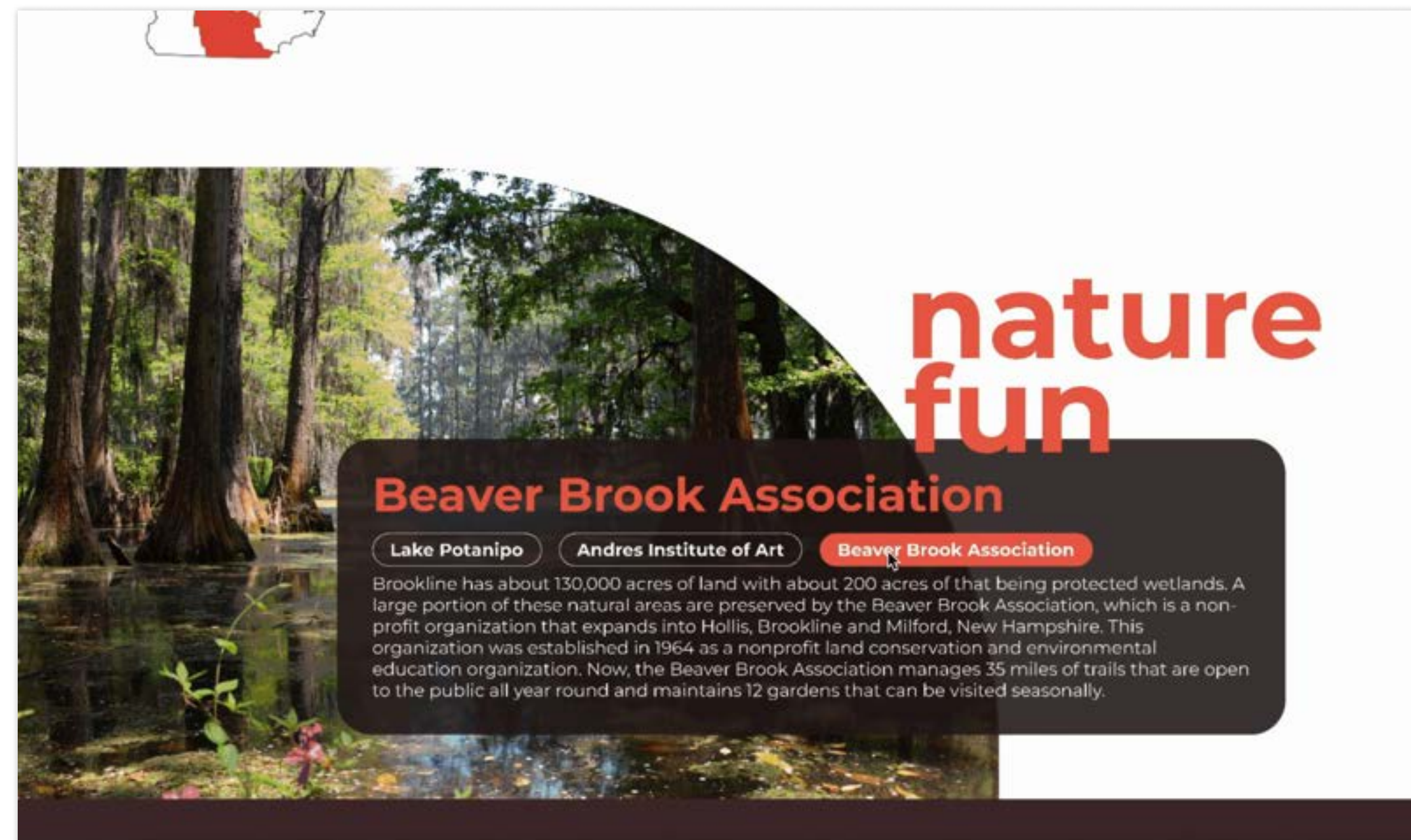
The town information slides out from behind the centered images and then pushes into the image with a rounded rectangle overlay to add character to this build in.



Process > Prototyping

About

The food and outdoors section take a spin on the idea of filtering through a carousel widget and borrows from the funky aesthetic through asymmetrical treatments, layering, and masked images. The sliding in of the image as the text rolls up or down creates a dynamic build-in and build-out of the scene.



Conclusion

Ending Thoughts

This website redesign of Brookline captures the fun and playful energy of the town through asymmetry and pops of vibrant red, while also leaning into the a more muted and versatile color palette. The micro-animations, inspired by the comparative analysis, adds to the youthful visuals of the redesign.

Conclusion

Like My Work?

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Email **megangarcia2024@gmail.com**

LinkedIn **@megangarcia-ux**



Thank You!